Impact Area Alignment

— Decarbonization

☑ Quality of Life

— Ecological Conservation and Restoration

Indoor Environmental Quality Credit

ACCESSIBILITY AND INCLUSION

EQc3

1–2 points

INTENT

To support the diverse needs of occupants and increase widespread usability of the building to foster an individual and collective sense of belonging.

REQUIREMENTS

Achievement Pathways	Points
Commercial Interiors	1–2
Accessibility and Inclusion Strategies	1–2

Comply with Local Accessibility Codes

Support access for those with physical disabilities by locating in a building that meets all locally applicable accessibility codes identified in the *IPp2: Human Impact Assessment*.

If there is no locally applicable code, the base building must include the following strategies:

- Accessible routes or regularly used exterior building entrances must have ramps to accommodate elevation changes.
- All doors meant for human passage from the main exterior building entrance to the project entrance have a minimum clear width of 32 inches (0.86 meters).
- Reception desks, security counters, and service counters within the project boundary all have a front-approach, wheelchair-accessible section.

AND

Include at least five (1 point) or 10 (2 points) of the following accessibility and inclusion strategies that go beyond the locally applicable accessibility code and are most relevant to the project:

Accessibility for Physical Diversity

- Provide wave-to-open or vertical hand/foot-press door operators at all regularly used building entrances.
- Design meeting spaces to accommodate mobility devices for at least 10% of occupants.

- Incorporate accessible and inclusive equipment and activities in fitness facilities. Ensure an open and accessible route to and around the equipment.
- Where inaccessible routes are provided (e.g., stairs), provide an alternate accessible route that starts and terminates at the same location.

Accessibility for Safety and Aging

- Provide nonslip flooring.
- Fix area rugs to the floor below and provide transition strips at all edges.
- Provide a visual indication or a railing at all full-height glazing, except in private residences.
- Provide audible and visual alerts for emergency alerts.
- Provide closed risers (visually and physically) in all stairs.
- Use visual contrast between walls and floors, walls and doors, and walls and casework.
- Provide visual, tactile, contrasting, or photoluminescent warnings at floor level changes.

Accessibility for Social Health

- Provide lactation rooms or pods.
- Provide at least one fully accessible, all-gender, single-user restroom OR one multiuser all-gender restroom on each floor of the building.
- Include at least one adult changing station or table in a designated, accessible restroom or family restroom, or in one men's and one women's restroom.
- Provide signage in all languages spoken by more than 5% of the local population.
- Support neurodivergent users by achieving *EQc2: Occupant Experience,* Option 1. Biophilic Environments, Path 1, Integrated Biophilic Design.

Accessibility for Navigation

- Provide wayfinding signage that clearly indicates exits, entrances, and major functions in the project.
- Provide nontext diagrams and symbols on signage.
- Provide Braille, visual and auditory cues, and/or continuous linear indicators on paths of travel.
- Use pattern and color blocking to identify key access spaces.
- Provide haptic/tactile maps for wayfinding.

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RESILIENT SPACES

EQc4

1–3 points

INTENT

To support design features that increase the capacity for occupants to adapt to changing climate conditions and be protected from events that may compromise the quality of the indoor environment and, subsequently, occupant health and well-being.

REQUIREMENTS

Achievement Pathways	Points
Commercial Interiors	1–3
Option 1. Management Mode for Episodic Outdoor Ambient Conditions	1
AND/OR	
Option 2. Management Mode for Respiratory Diseases	1
AND/OR	
Option 3. Design for Occupant Thermal Safety During Power Outages	1–2
Path 1. Consider Extreme Heat	1
AND/OR	
Path 2. Consider Extreme Cold	1
AND/OR	
Option 4. Operable Windows	1–2

Comply with any of the following options for up to 2 points.

Option 1. Management Mode for Episodic Outdoor Ambient Conditions (1 point)

Design systems with the capability to operate an episodic outdoor event management mode as described in *ASHRAE Guideline 44*. The mode should address varying outdoor conditions or events that could negatively influence indoor air quality, such as wildland fire smoke. Include the management mode in the design and commissioning documents. Verify proper implementation of the mode during commissioning.

AND/OR

Option 2. Management Mode for Respiratory Diseases (1 point)

Design occupied spaces with the capability to operate an infection risk management mode that provides the minimum equivalent clean airflow rates outlined in *ASHRAE 241-2023*, Section 5.1. Include the management mode in the design and commissioning documents as outlined in

ASHRAE 241-2023, Section B10.2, “Design Documentation.” Verify proper implementation of the mode during commissioning.

AND/OR

Option 3. Design for Occupant Thermal Safety During Power Outages (1–2 points)

PATH 1. CONSIDER EXTREME HEAT (1 POINT)

Demonstrate through thermal modeling that a building will passively maintain thermally habitable conditions during a power outage that lasts two days during peak summertime conditions of a typical meteorological year. Designate specific thermal safety zones where habitable conditions will be maintained during a power outage.

AND/OR

PATH 2. CONSIDER EXTREME COLD (1 POINT)

Demonstrate through thermal modeling or Passive House certification that a building will passively maintain thermally habitable conditions during a power outage that lasts two days during peak wintertime conditions of a typical meteorological year. Designate specific thermal safety zones where habitable conditions will be maintained during a power outage.

AND/OR

Option 4. Operable Windows (1–2 points)

Design 50% (for 1 point) or 75% (for 2 points) of the regularly occupied spaces to have operable windows with the capability to provide access to outdoor air during heat waves or localized power outages. The windows must meet the opening size and location requirements of *ASHRAE 62.1-2022,* Section 6.4.

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AIR QUALITY TESTING AND MONITORING

EQc5

1–4 points

INTENT

To support better management of IAQ and identify opportunities for health-based approaches to building operations.

REQUIREMENTS

Achievement Pathways	Points
Commercial Interiors	1–4
Option 1. Pre-Occupancy Air Testing	1–2
Path 1. Particulate Matter and Inorganic Gases	1
AND/OR	
Path 2. Volatile Organic Compounds	1
AND/OR	
Option 2. Continuous Indoor Air Monitoring	1

Option 1. Pre-Occupancy Air Testing (1–2 points)

After construction ends and before occupancy, but under ventilation conditions typical for occupancy, conduct baseline IAQ testing. Retail projects may conduct the testing within 14 days of occupancy. The number of measurements should be specified according to Table 1 and taken in respective locations of the building.

Table 1. Number of Measurements Required for Preoccupancy Air Testing

Total Occupied Floor Area, sq. ft (sq. m.)	Number of Measurements
≤ 5,000 (500)	1
> 5,000 (500) and ≤ 15,000 (1,500)	2
> 15,000 (1,500) and ≤ 25,000 (2,500)	3
> 25,000 (2,500) and ≤ 200,000 (20,000)	4 plus one additional measurement per each 25,000 sq. ft. (2,500 sq. m.) above 25,000 sq. ft.

Total Occupied Floor Area, sq. ft (sq. m.)	Number of Measurements
> 200,000 (20,000)	10 plus one additional measurement per each 50,000 sq. ft. (4,600 sq. m.) above 200,000 sq. ft.

PATH 1. PARTICULATE MATTER AND INORGANIC GASES (1 POINT)

Test for the particulate matter (PM) and inorganic gases listed in Table 2, using an allowed test method, and demonstrate that the contaminants do not exceed the concentration limits listed in the table. Measure for a four-hour period and calculate the peak concentration for carbon monoxide and average concentration for ozone, PM2.5, and PM10.

Table 2. Limits for Particulate Matter and Inorganic Gases

Contaminant (CAS#)	Concentration Limit (µg/m^3)	Allowed Test Methods (laboratory-based)	Direct Reading Instrument Minimum Specifications
Carbon monoxide (CO)	9 ppm; no more than 2 ppm above outdoor levels	*ISO 4224* EPA Compendium Method *IP-3* *GB/T 18883-2002* for projects in China	Direct calibrated electrochemical instrument with accuracy of ± 3% of reading and resolution of 0.1 ppm NDIR CO sensors with accuracy of 1% of 10 ppm full scale and display resolution of less than 0.1 ppm
Particulates (for projects in attainment areas)	ISO class 8 or lower per *ISO 14644-1:2015* OR meet PM10: 50 µg/m^3 PM2.5: 12 µg/m^3	n/a *IP-10A*	Accuracy (±): Greater of 5 µg/m^3 or 20% of reading Resolution (±): 5 µg/m^3
Particulates (for projects in nonattainment areas)	I*SO* class 8 or lower per *ISO* 14644-1:2015 OR meet PM10: 50 µg/m^3 PM2.5: 35 µg/m^3	n/a *IP-10A*	Accuracy (±): Greater of 5 µg/m^3 or 20% of reading Resolution (±): 5 µg/m^3